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Agri Monitor #41

Agribusiness, Food & Beverage Team

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Agri Monitor #41: If All You Have Is Five Minutes…

- This is the #41 edition of our Agri Monitor, which summarizes the key data points we find useful in monitoring our areas of coverage. We have a structurally bullish view on Brazilian Agribusiness but are more selective on a relative basis. **3tentos is our Top Pick** in the Agri coverage. We prefer Grains over the S&E segment, although we acknowledge the lack of short-term triggers across most of the Agribusiness sector.

Company	Recommendation	TP	Year End	Upside
SLCE3	OP	BRL 23.0	2026	**44%**
AGRO3	MP	BRL 24.0	2026	**18%**
TTEN3	OP	BRL 20.0	2026	**25%**
VITT3	OP	BRL 7.0	2026	**65%**
SOJA3	MP	BRL 10.0	2026	**22%**
SMTO3	OP	BRL 31.0	2026	**97%**
JALL3	OP	BRL 4.0	2027	**31%**

Crops

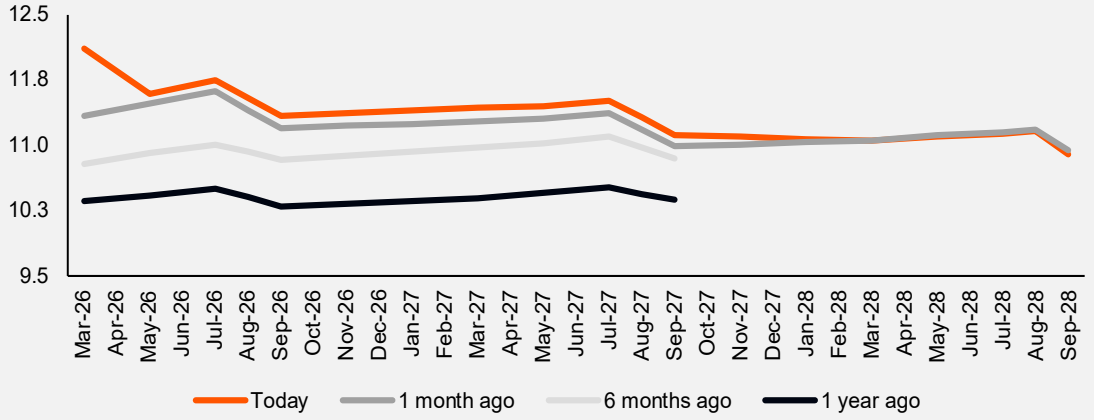
- Soybean prices in Chicago have risen 18% YTD, supported by robust biofuel demand and further intensified by geopolitical conflicts in the Middle East. In contrast, Brazilian prices have declined ~5% over the same period, reflecting strong harvest progress and improving productivity expectations. On the export side, recent headlines suggest potential headwinds for Brazil, with uncertainty around China's import inspection procedures and the risk of a truckers' strike following the latest increase in diesel prices potentially disrupting freight flows (check here and here). Beyond the boost to soybean demand from biofuel mandates, the recent spike in nitrogen fertilizer prices may increase U.S. corn production costs and reinforce the ongoing shift in acreage from corn to soybeans, an important trend to monitor in upcoming planting projections. In Brazil, upward price risks are compounded by domestic factors, including growing concerns about yield losses in the 2nd corn crop due to adverse weather and solid demand from expanding corn ethanol operations. For cotton, uncertainty surrounding the duration of geopolitical conflicts and their macroeconomic impacts remains high, but a scenario of elevated oil prices could improve cotton's competitiveness relative to synthetic fibers, providing some support to demand. Despite the recent spike in nitrogen-based fertilizers, it is still early in the cost-formation cycle for Brazilian producers, giving them room to delay purchases in anticipation of more favorable pricing if geopolitical pressures ease. In the soybean-crushing segment, margins have improved sequentially in 1Q26 as seasonality suggests, driven mainly by lower soybean costs, which more than offset recent declines in biodiesel and soybean-meal prices. On the regulatory front, while the delay of the B16 blend in March was largely anticipated, the latest increase in diesel prices has renewed discussions around a potential shift to B17 to help ease supply conditions. Despite continued industry pressure for a higher blend, authorities have so far ruled out this adjustment, pointing instead to ongoing technical tests, expected to conclude by the end of 1H26 (check the news), and to alternative short-term measures highlighted in recent announcements.

Sugar & Ethanol

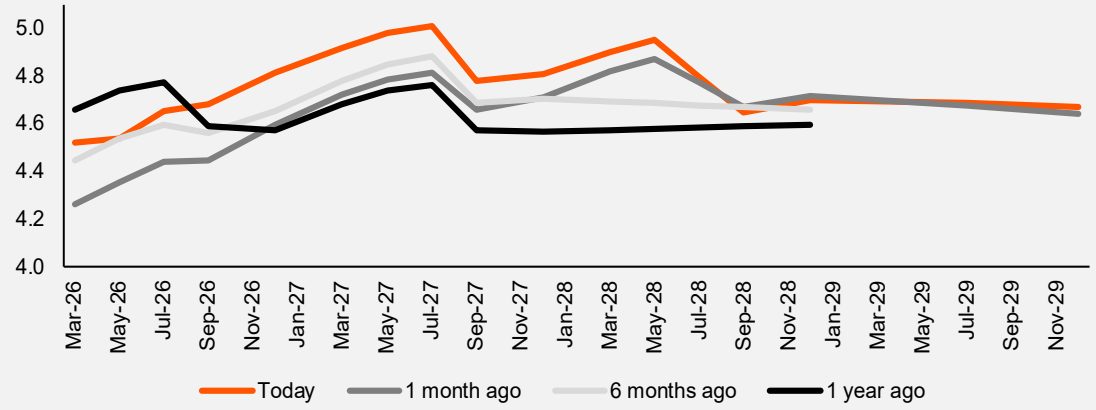
- Ethanol prices in Brazil have been on a steady sequential decline since peaking in January, but recent geopolitical tensions have renewed investor discussions about potential price support through gasoline-ethanol parity. While this backdrop could offer some uplift for S&E pricing, it is important to note that domestic gasoline prices remain subject to Brazil's internal pricing mandate. Any pass-through of global fuel volatility to local gasoline could, in turn, support ethanol prices. In the current environment, S&E equivalent pricing still favors ethanol over sugar production, a dynamic that if sustained could provide a floor for sugar prices, which are trading near USD ~14.4 c/lb. We also highlight that hedge funds continue to hold sizable short positions in sugar, increasing the potential for an amplified rebound should market sentiment shift, even though the broader upside remains capped by strong output across major producing regions. With the Brazilian harvest nearing completion and broadly aligned with the expected ~605 million tons crushing for the 2025/26 season, any material upside for NY sugar prices is more likely to originate from production or export developments in Asia, or from domestic gasoline pricing decisions if geopolitical conflicts in the Middle East persist. Within this context, S&E companies could still benefit from global pricing dynamics that incentivize S&E output in the near term, especially in an environment of higher oil prices. However, once markets normalize, structural headwinds remain evident, given the ongoing recovery in global sugar supply, with robust production from major exporters, including Brazil, and elevated output in both sugarcane and corn-based ethanol this year.

Futures Curves: Price expectations for soft commodities have improved following geopolitical conflicts in the Middle East

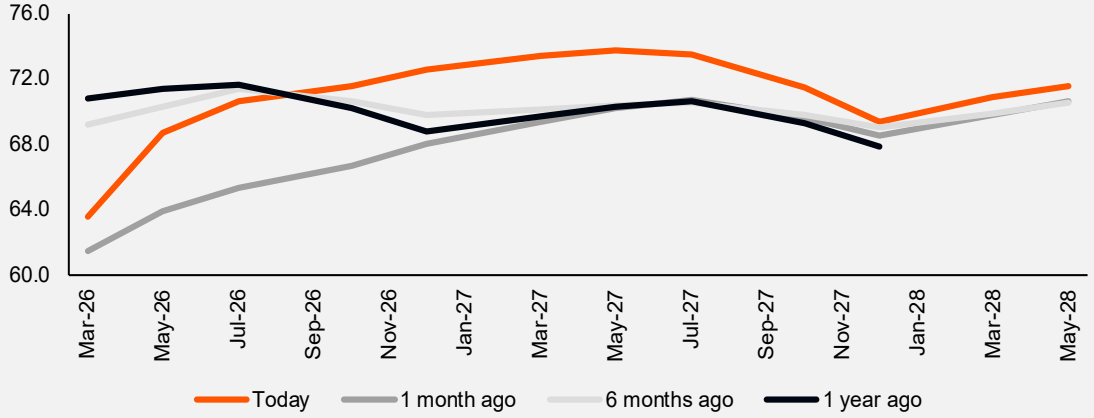
Soybean Futures Curves (USD/bushel)



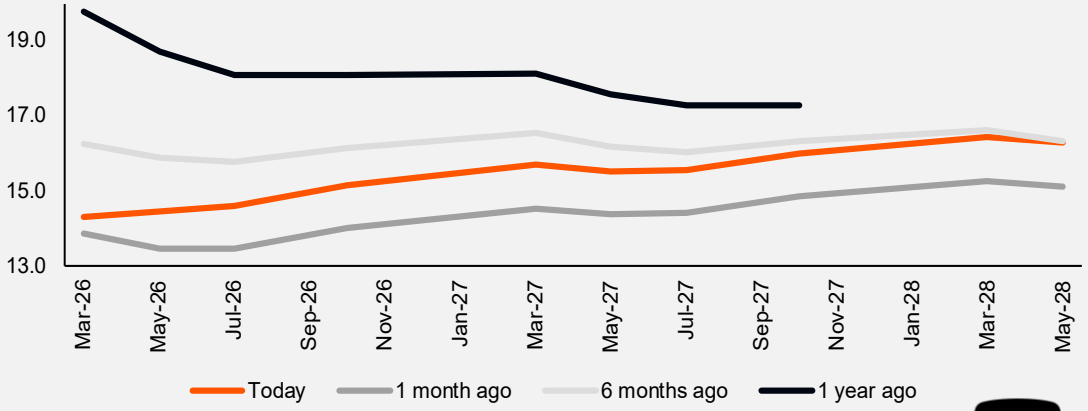
Corn Futures Curves (USD/bushel)



Cotton Futures Curves (USDc/lb)



Sugar Futures Curves (USDc/lb)

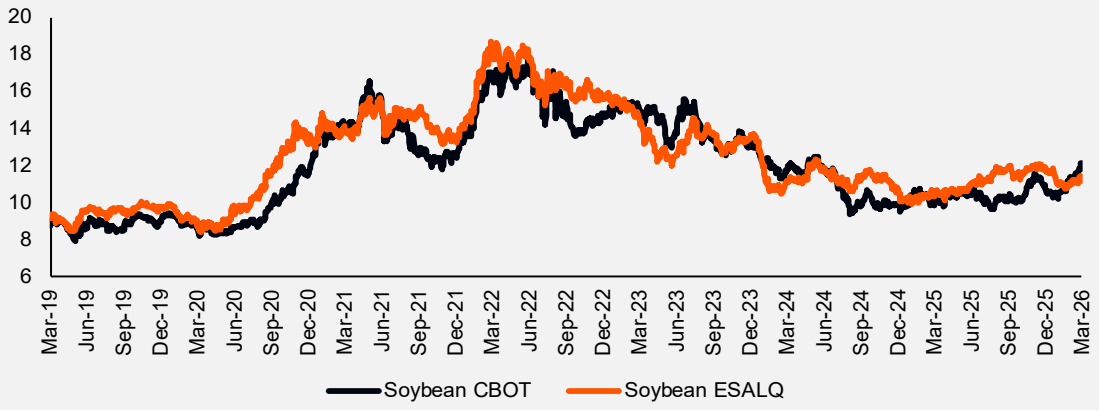


Source: Itaú BBA, Bloomberg

1 Soybean

Soybean – Prices: Chicago price has increased by 18% YTD, while in Brazil it has declined by 5% due to solid harvest development, creating a CBOT premium over BZ prices

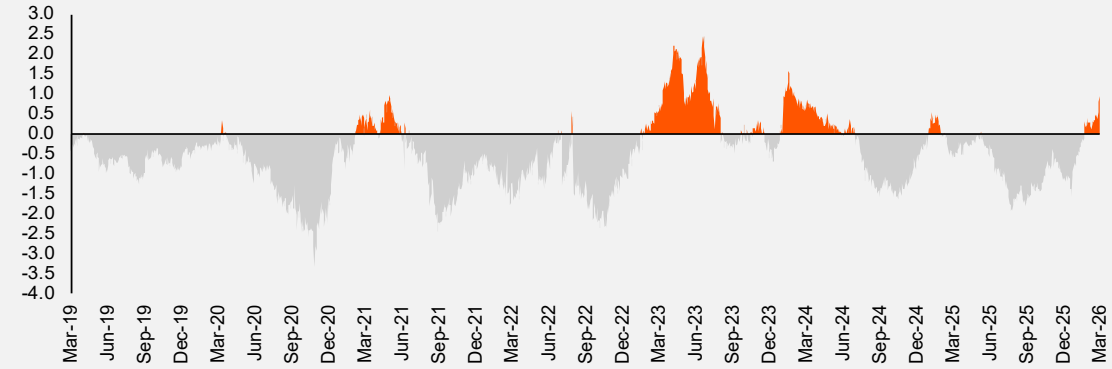
Soybean Prices: Brazil vs. Chicago (USD/bushel)



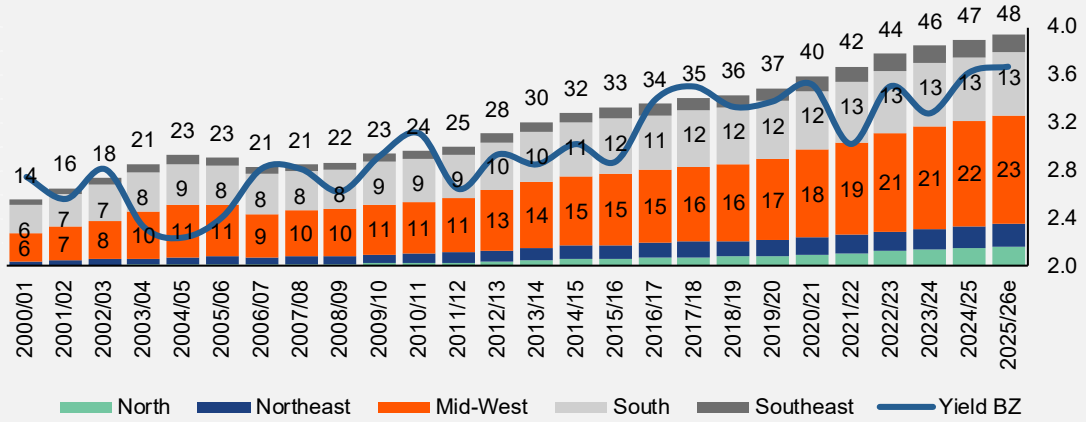
Global Soybean Supply and Demand Outlook (million tons)

	2020/21A	2021/22A	2022/23A	2023/24A	2024/25A	2025/26E (Feb)	2025/26E (Mar)
Production	**370**	**361**	**378**	**395**	**424**	**427**	**424**
Brazil	140	131	162	153	169	180	180
USA	115	122	116	113	119	116	116
Argentina	46	44	25	48	51	49	48
Domestic Use	**367**	**366**	**366**	**384**	**411**	**425**	**424**
China	115	110	118	122	127	133	133
USA	61	63	63	66	69	73	73
Brazil	50	54	57	59	61	65	65
Ending Stocks	**99**	**93**	**101**	**112**	**125**	**126**	**125**
Stock to Use	*27%*	*25%*	*28%*	*29%*	*30%*	*29.5%*	*29.5%*

Soybean Basis (Simplified): Paranaguá x Chicago (USD/bushel)



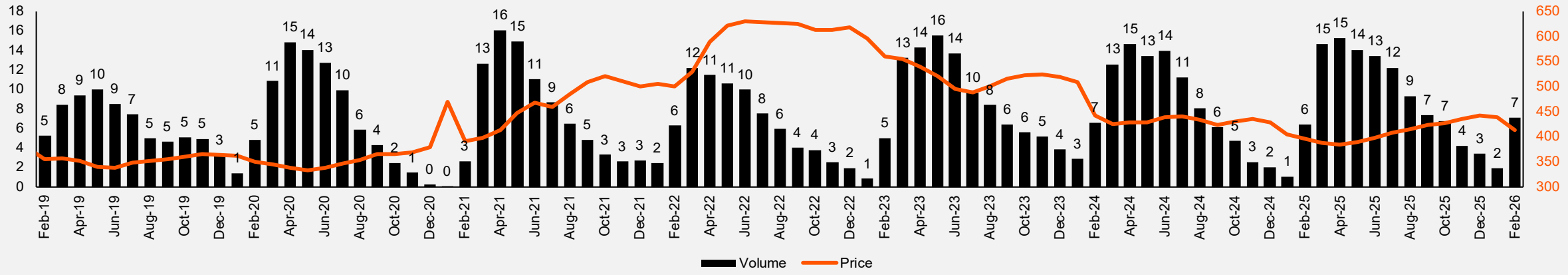
Soybean: Brazilian Planted Area (mn ha, LHS) and Yield (ton/ha, RHS)



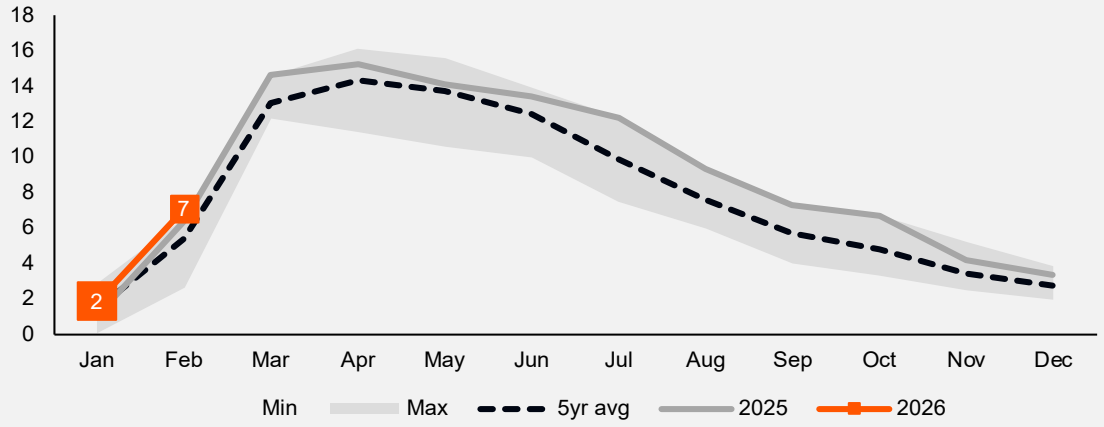
Source: Itaú BBA, Bloomberg, USDA, CONAB

Soybean – Brazilian Exports: Volumes increased by 11% YoY in February, driven by the harvest development in Brazil, while prices are 4% higher YoY

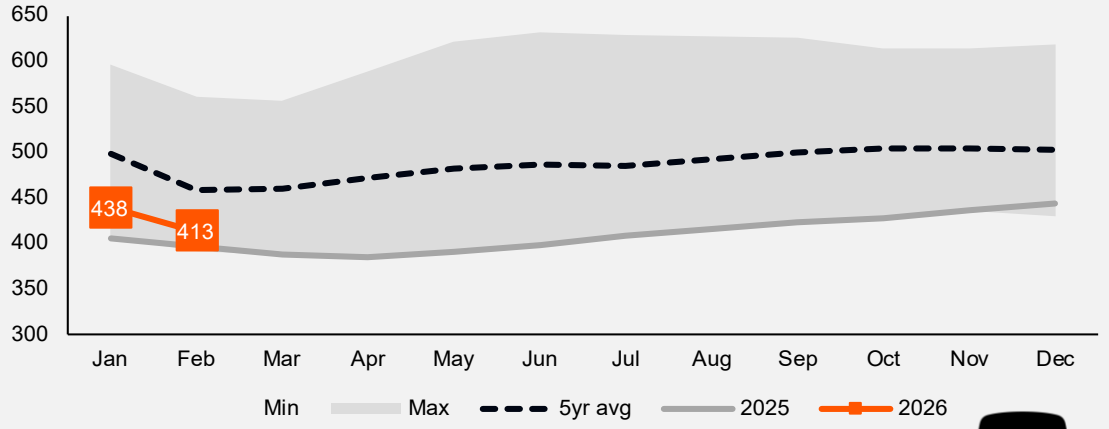
Soybean: Brazil Monthly Export Volumes (million tons) **and Price** (USD/ton)



Soybean: Brazil Monthly Export Volumes (million tons)



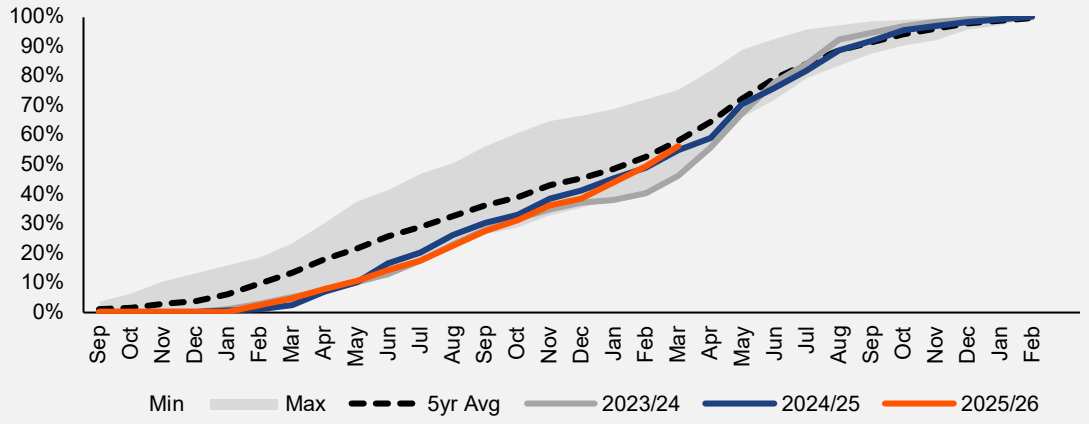
Soybean: Brazil Monthly Average Price (USD/ton)



Source: Itaú BBA, SECEX

Soybean – Mato Grosso: Harvest is almost concluded under healthy conditions, while farmer selling accelerated in March due to favorable price conditions, also benefiting producer margins MoM

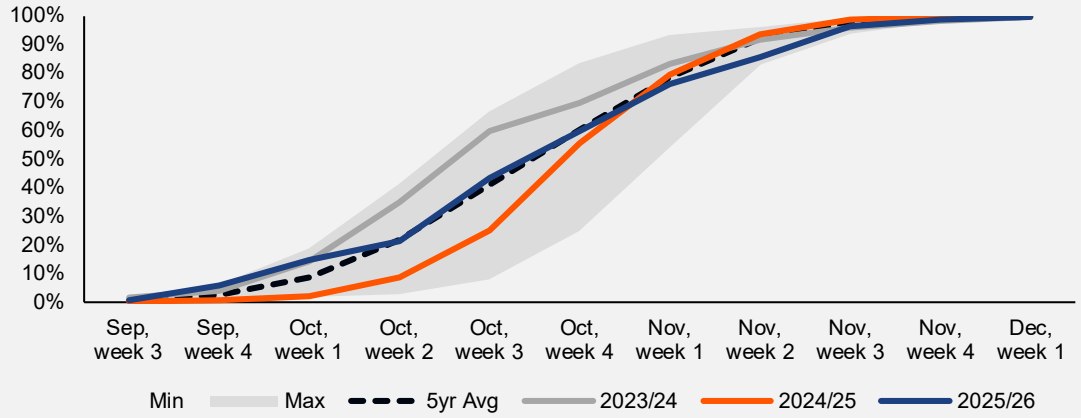
Soybean Farmer Selling Progression in Mato Grosso (%)



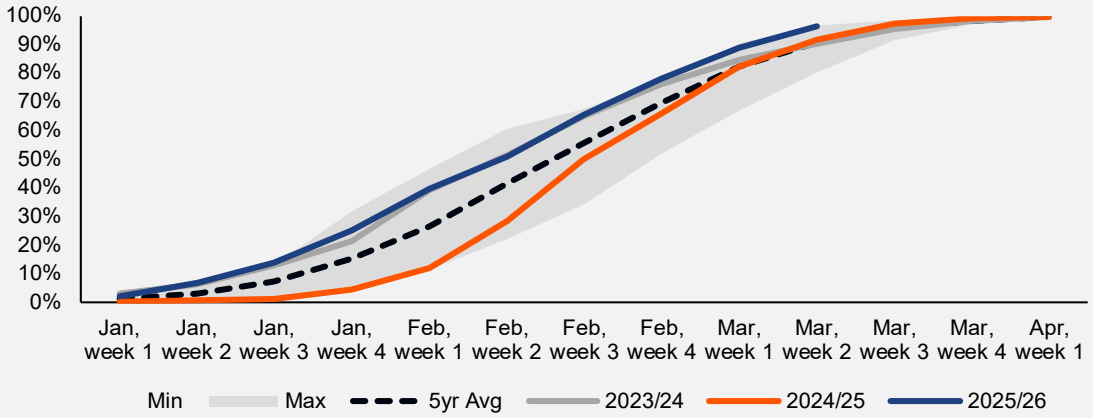
Soybean Production Costs in Mato Grosso (BRL/Hectare)

BRL/hectare	2019/20	2020/21	2021/22	2022/23	2023/24	2024/25	2025/26	2026/27e (Feb)	YoY
Seeds	336	349	495	882	727	724	599	475	-21%
Fertilizers	910	907	1,141	2,417	1,805	1,646	1,879	1,870	0%
Pesticides	829	934	1,078	1,373	1,305	968	1,226	1,298	6%
Others Costs	1,168	1,116	1,358	1,644	1,856	1,926	2,072	2,163	4%
Cash COGS	**3,243**	**3,305**	**4,072**	**6,316**	**5,692**	**5,263**	**5,777**	**5,806**	**1%**
Unit Revenues	5,342	9,081	10,040	8,459	6,055	7,182	6,811	6,171	-9%
Avg Yield (bag/ha)	60	58	62	63	53	60	60	60	0%
Price Assumption (BRL/bag)	89	156	161	135	114	119	113	102	-9%
Proxy Margin	2,099	5,775	5,967	2,143	363	1,919	1,035	365	-65%
Gross Margin	**39%**	**64%**	**59%**	**25%**	**6%**	**27%**	**15%**	**6%**	**n.a.**

Soybean Seeding Progression in Mato Grosso (%)



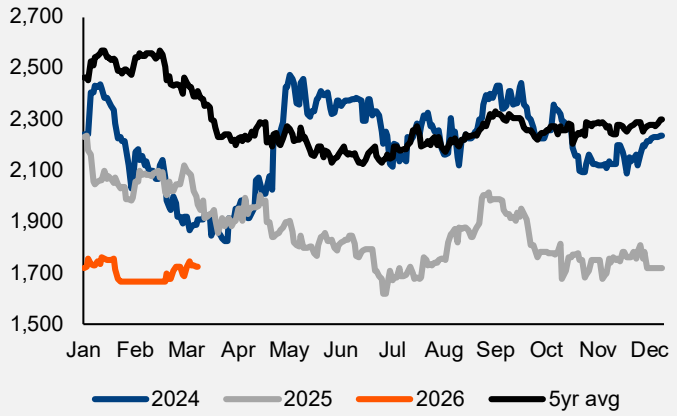
Soybean Harvesting Progression in Mato Grosso (%)



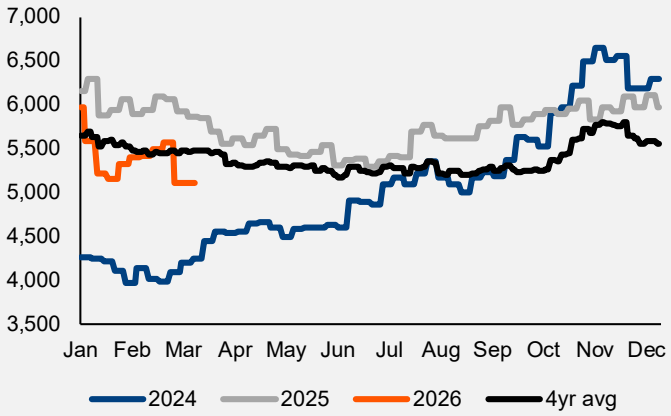
Source: Itaú BBA, IMEA

Soybean Crushing: In 1Q26 so far, spreads have expanded QoQ in both RS and MT, mainly driven by lower grain costs to offset the decline in biodiesel prices

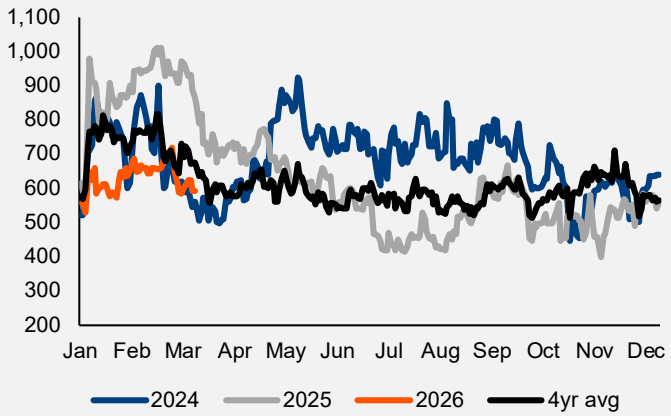
Soybean Meal Price in MT (BRL/ton)



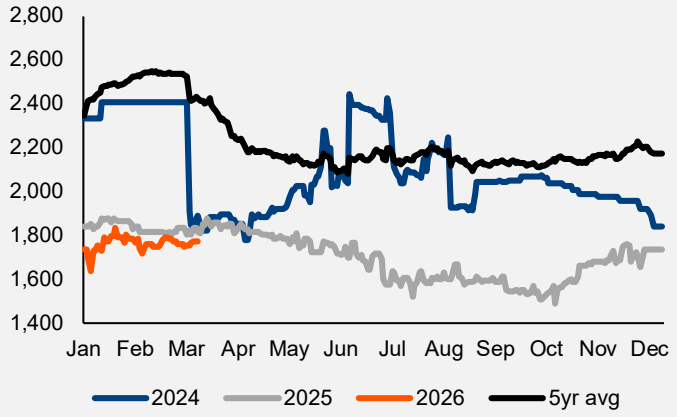
Biodiesel Price in Center-West Region (BRL/ton)



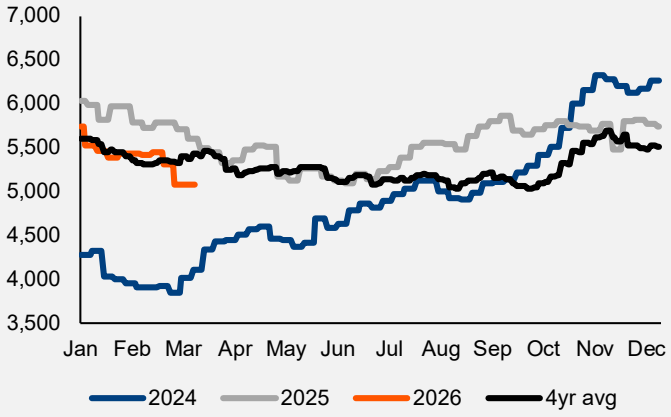
Soybean Crushing Margin in MT (BRL/ton)



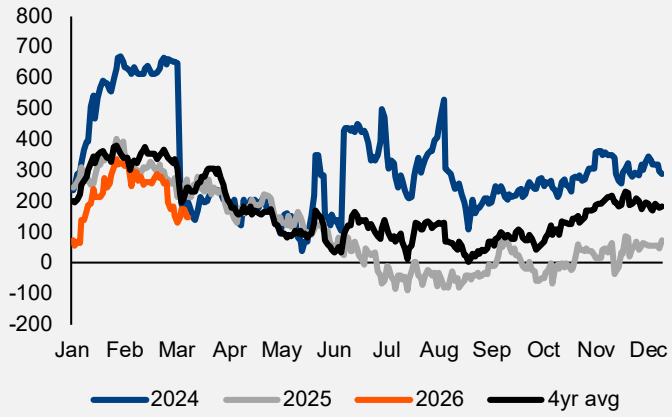
Soybean Meal Price in PR (BRL/ton)



Biodiesel Price in South Region (BRL/ton)



Soybean Crushing Margin in RS (BRL/ton)

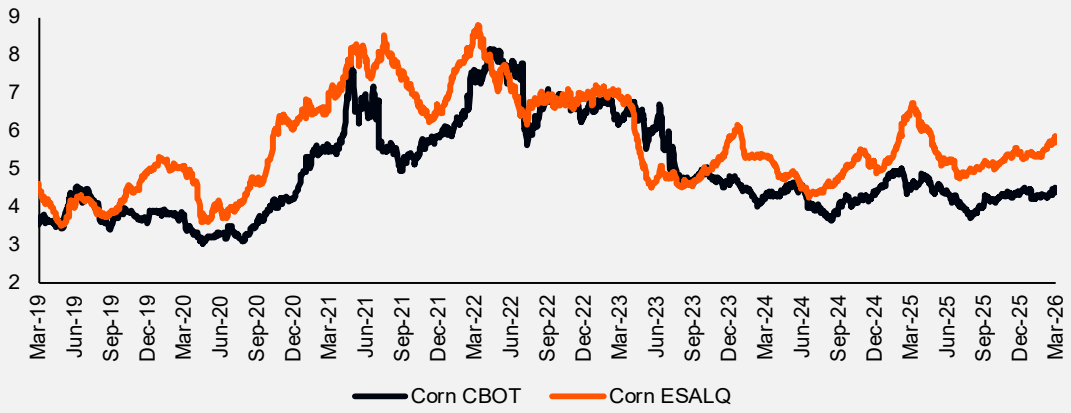


Source: Itaú BBA, ANP, Bloomberg

2 Corn

Corn – Prices: The BZ premium over CBOT remains resilient, given solid domestic consumption in Brazil coupled with risks related to second crop productivity

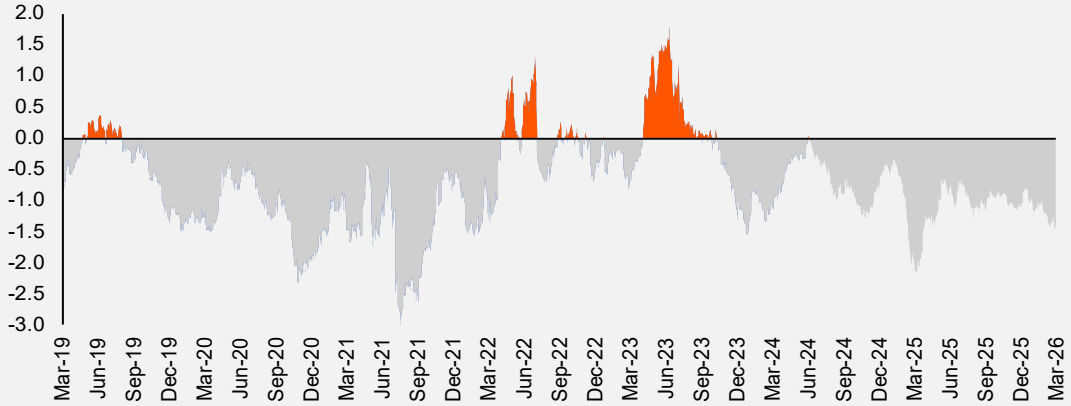
Corn Prices: Brazil vs. Chicago (USD/bushel)



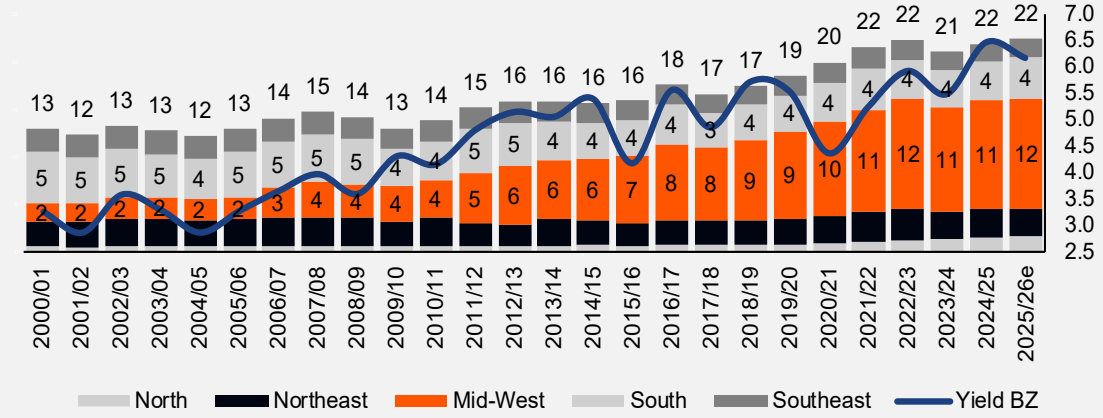
Global Corn Supply and Demand Outlook (million tons)

	2020/21A	2021/22A	2022/23A	2023/24A	2024/25A	2025/26E (Feb)	2025/26E (Mar)
Production	**1,134**	**1,219**	**1,163**	**1,230**	**1,226**	**1,296**	**1,297**
USA	358	381	347	390	378	432	432
China	261	273	277	289	295	301	301
Brazil	87	116	137	122	132	131	132
Use	**1,153**	**1,179**	**1,166**	**1,222**	**1,259**	**1,301**	**1,301**
USA	308	316	306	322	318	335	335
China	285	291	299	307	316	321	321
Brazil	71	71	78	85	91	97	96
Ending Stocks	**296**	**314**	**305**	**317**	**283**	**289**	**293**
Stock to Use	*26%*	*27%*	*26%*	*26%*	*22%*	*22.2%*	*22.5%*

Corn Basis (Simplified): Campinas x Chicago (USD/bushel)



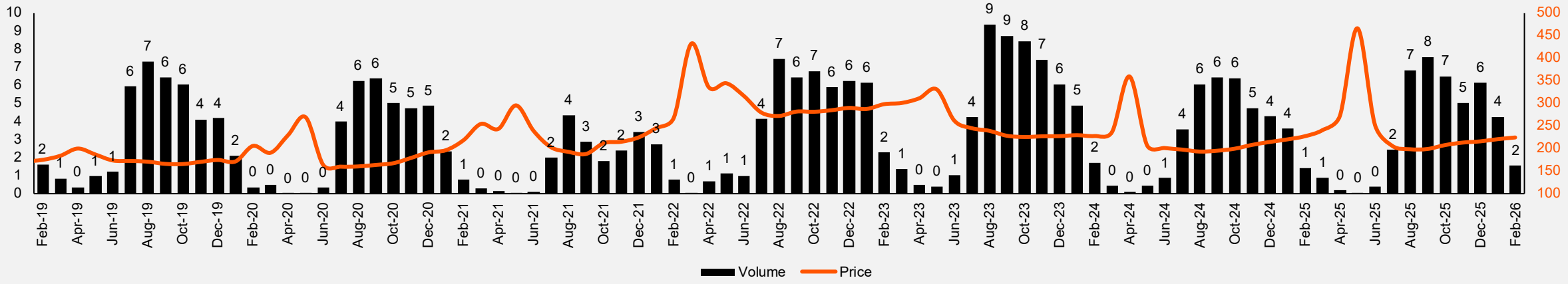
Corn: Brazilian Planted Area (mn ha, LHS) **and Yield** (ton/ha, RHS)



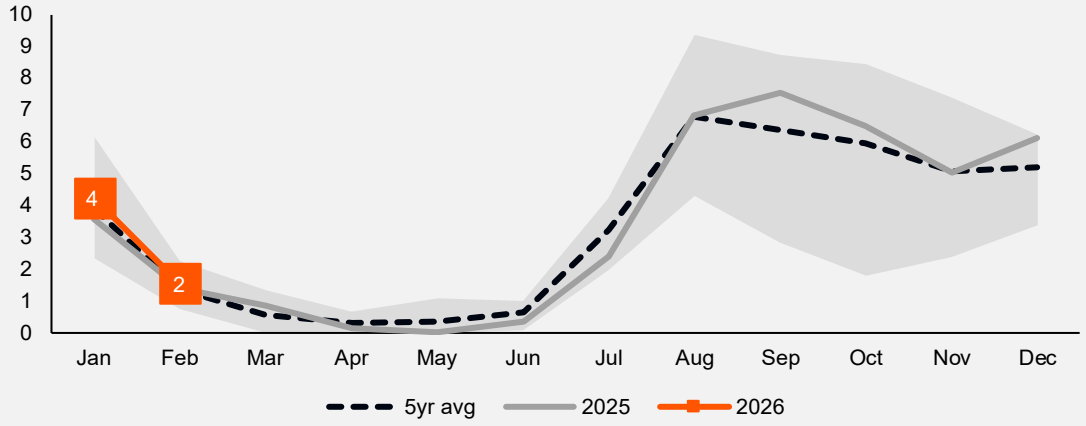
Source: Itaú BBA, Bloomberg, USDA, CONAB

Corn – Brazilian Exports: Volumes in February declined MoM as seasonality suggests, while export prices remained below the historical average

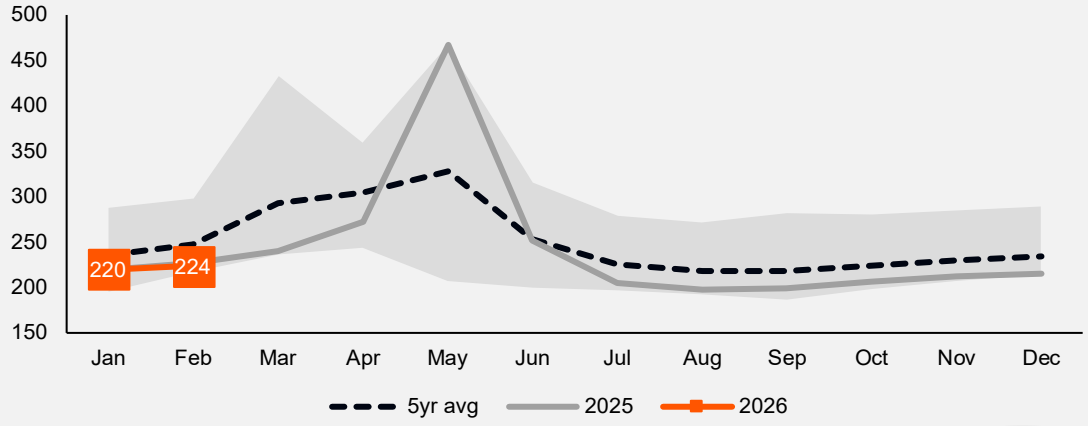
Corn: Brazil Monthly Export Volumes (million tons) **and Price** (USD/ton)



Corn: Brazil Monthly Export Volumes (million tons)



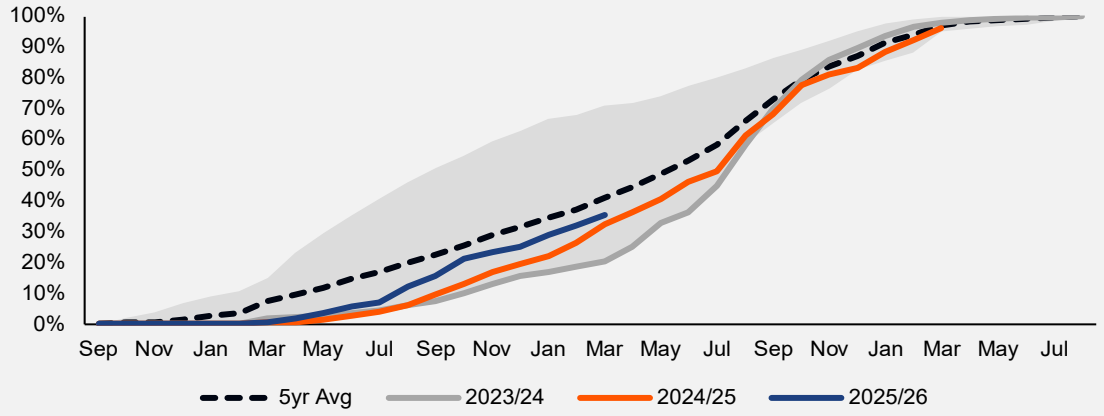
Corn: Brazil Monthly Average Price (USD/ton)



Source: Itaú BBA, SECEX

Corn – Mato Grosso: Farmer selling remains at a healthy level; Seeding period is slightly delayed compared to the historical average; Producer margins for 2026/27e may potentially be affected by higher fertilizer costs

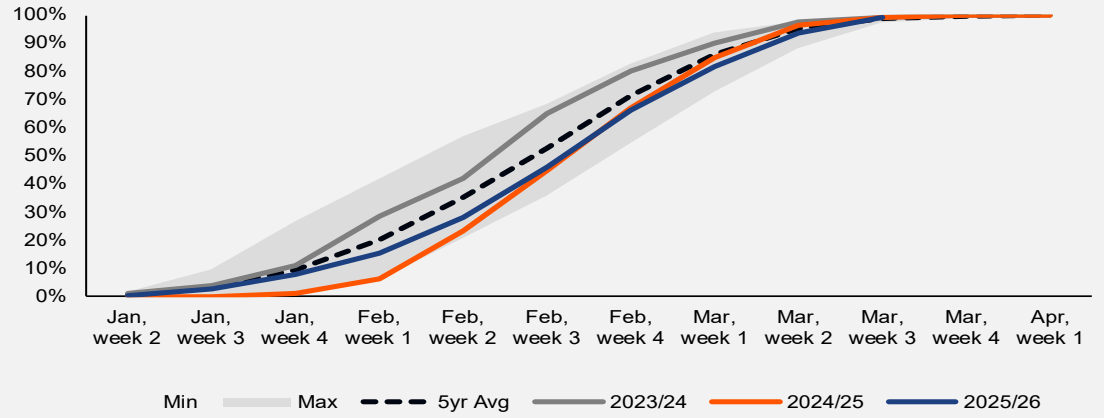
Corn Farmer Selling Progression in Mato Grosso (%)



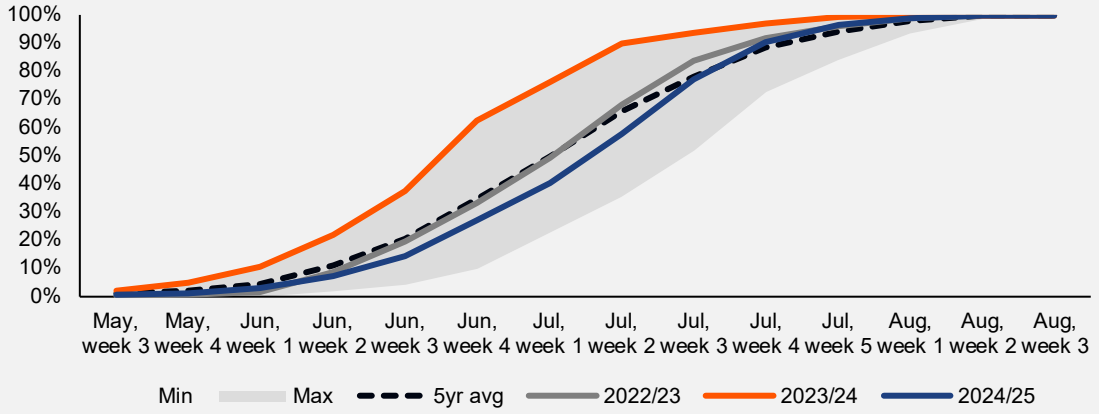
Corn Production Costs in Mato Grosso (BRL/Hectare)

BRL/hectare	2020/21	2021/22	2022/23	2023/24	2024/25	2025/26	2026/27e (Feb)	YoY
Seeds	445	554	671	751	738	815	843	3%
Fertilizers	736	1,169	1,817	1,519	1,557	1,474	1,387	-6%
Pesticides	398	469	586	733	687	763	867	14%
Others Costs	1,004	1,190	1,348	1,477	1,821	1,873	2,165	16%
Cash COGS	**2,583**	**3,382**	**4,421**	**4,480**	**4,802**	**4,925**	**5,263**	**6.9%**
Unit Revenues	2,322	4,841	8,538	5,221	4,891	5,888	6,272	7%
Avg Yield (bag/ha)	98	109	124	118	110	111	130	17%
Price Assumption (BRL/bag)	24	44	69	44	45	53	48	-9%
Proxy Margin	**-262**	**1,459**	**4,118**	**741**	**88**	**963**	**1,008**	**n.a.**
Gross Margin	-11%	30%	48%	14%	2%	16%	16%	n.a.

Corn Seeding Progression in Mato Grosso (%)



Corn Harvesting Progression in Mato Grosso (%)

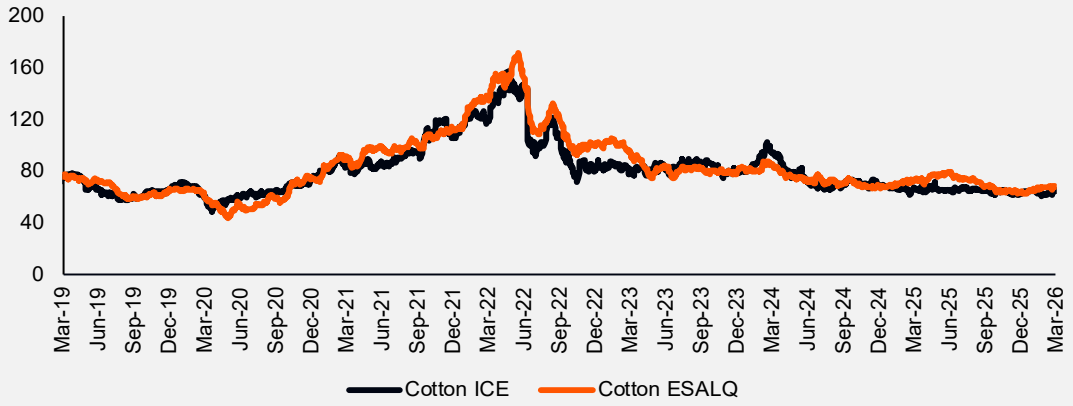


Source: Itaú BBA, IMEA

3 Cotton

Cotton – Prices: The USDA slightly increased the global stock-to-use ratio, which continues to exert pressure on persistently compressed global prices

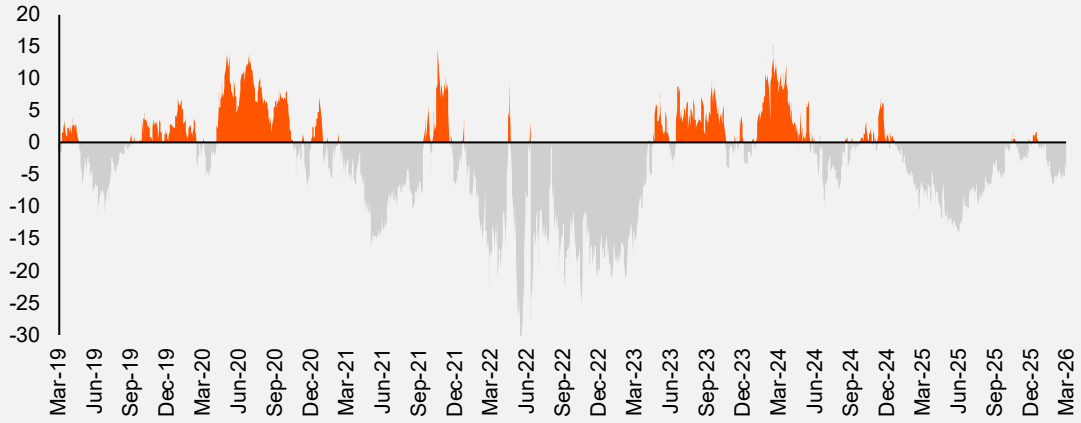
Cotton Prices: Brazil vs. New York (USDc/lb)



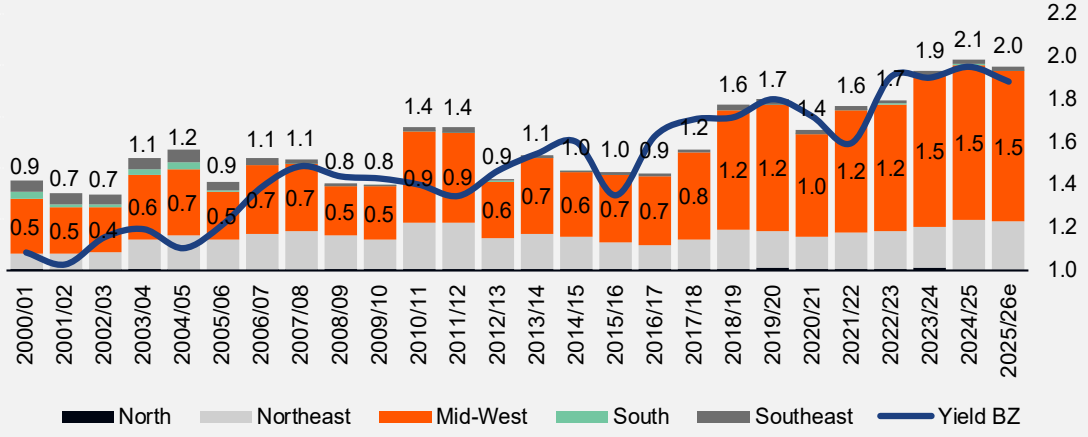
Global Cotton Supply and Demand Outlook (million tons)

	2019/20A	2020/21A	2021/22A	2022/23A	2023/24A	2024/25E	2025/26E (Feb)	2025/26E (Mar)
Production	**25.9**	**24.7**	**24.9**	**25.3**	**24.6**	**26.1**	**26.1**	**26.3**
China	6.0	6.4	5.8	6.7	6.0	7.0	7.6	7.7
India	6.2	6.0	5.3	5.7	5.5	5.2	5.1	5.7
Brazil	2.8	3.0	2.4	2.6	3.2	3.7	4.1	4.2
Use	**22.9**	**27.1**	**25.2**	**24.5**	**24.9**	**25.4**	**25.8**	**25.8**
China	7.5	9.0	7.3	8.2	8.4	8.1	8.5	8.6
India	4.5	5.7	5.4	5.3	5.6	5.4	5.4	5.4
Pakistan	2.1	2.4	2.3	1.9	2.1	2.3	2.4	2.3
Ending Stocks	**19.2**	**15.8**	**15.4**	**16.5**	**16.1**	**16.8**	**16.4**	**16.6**
Stock to Use	*84%*	*58%*	*61.2%*	*67%*	*65%*	*66%*	*63.3%*	*64.4%*

Cotton Basis (Simplified): Brazil x New York (USDc/lb)



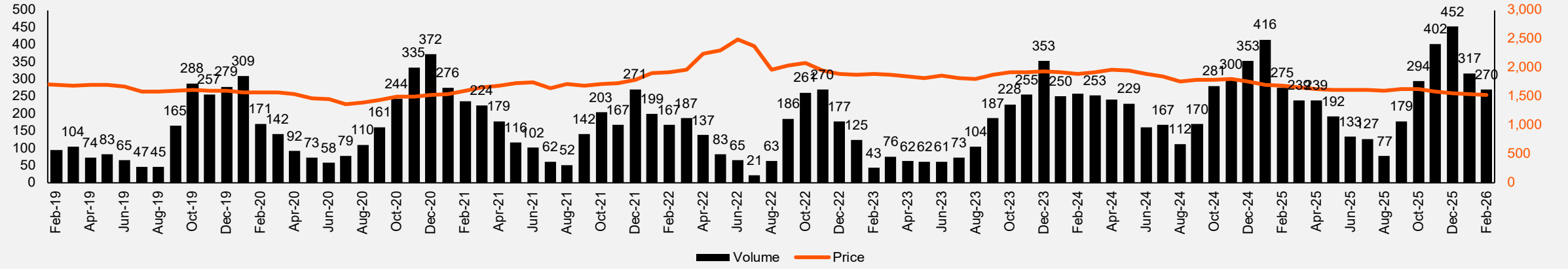
Cotton: Brazilian Planted Area (mn ha, LHS) **and Yield** (ton/ha, RHS)



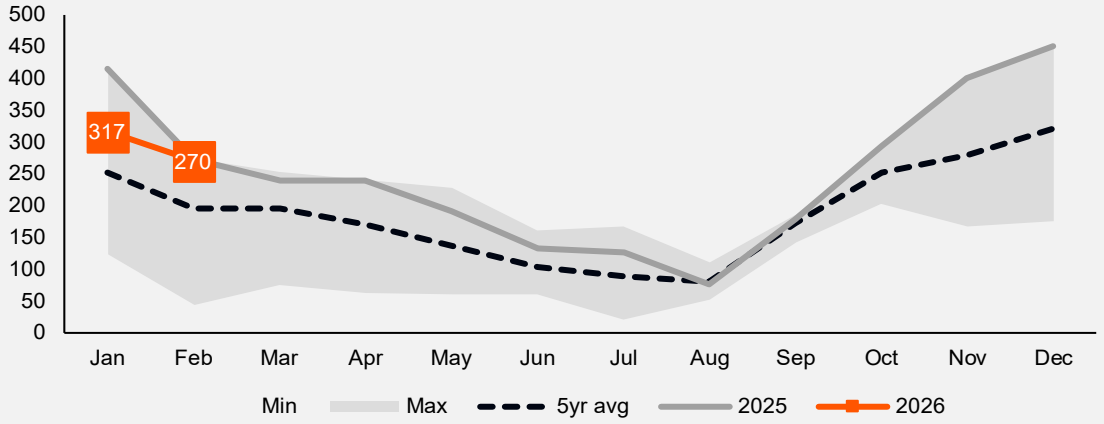
Source: Itaú BBA, Bloomberg, USDA, CONAB

Cotton – Brazilian Exports: Following strong FY25 performance, volumes in February decreased by 1.5% YoY, while prices declined by 9% YoY, reflecting the persistently compressed pricing environment

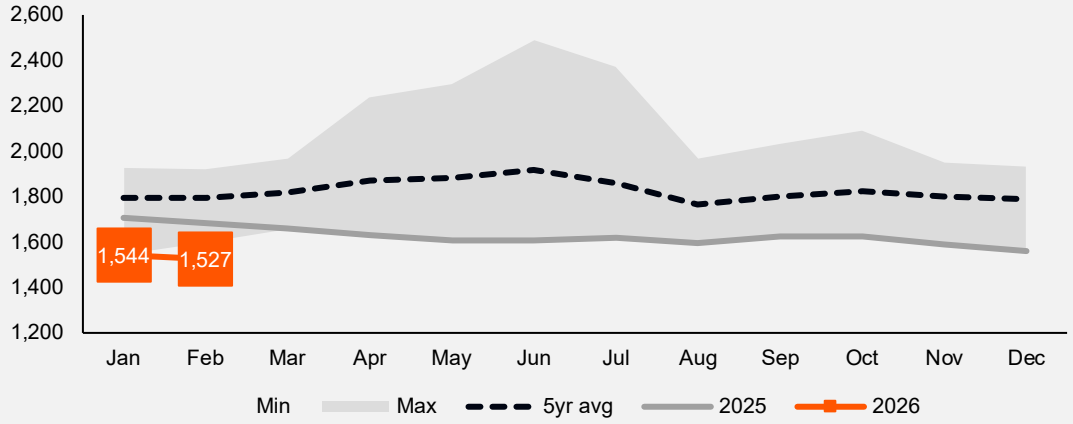
Cotton: Brazil Monthly Export Volumes (ktons) **and Price** (USD/ton)



Cotton: Brazil Monthly Export Volumes (ktons)



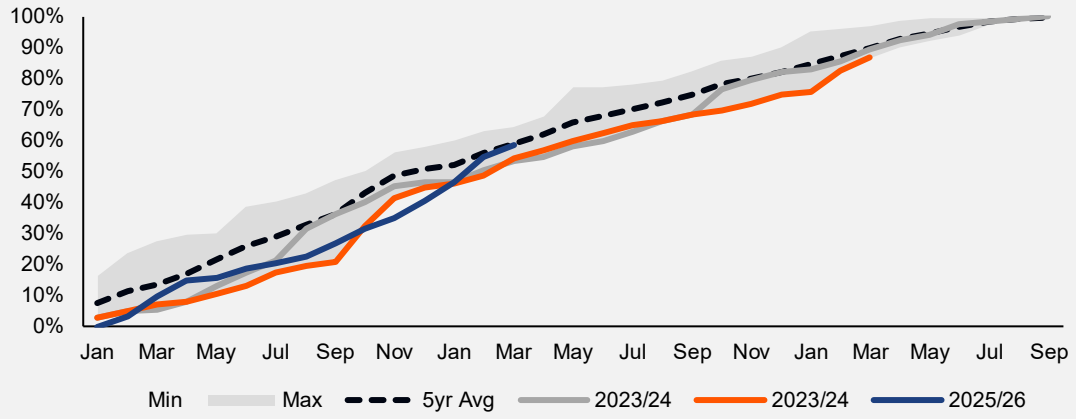
Cotton: Brazil Monthly Average Price (USD/ton)



Source: Itaú BBA, SECEX

Cotton – Mato Grosso: Farmer selling have recently accelerated considering a slight global price recovery; Producer margins for 2026/27 are expected to compress YoY, further intensified by potentially higher costs

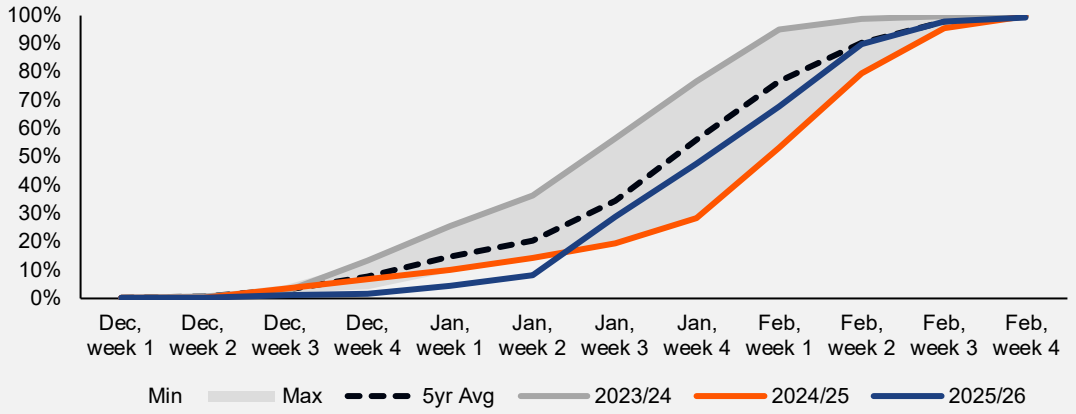
Cotton Farmer Selling Progression in Mato Grosso (%)



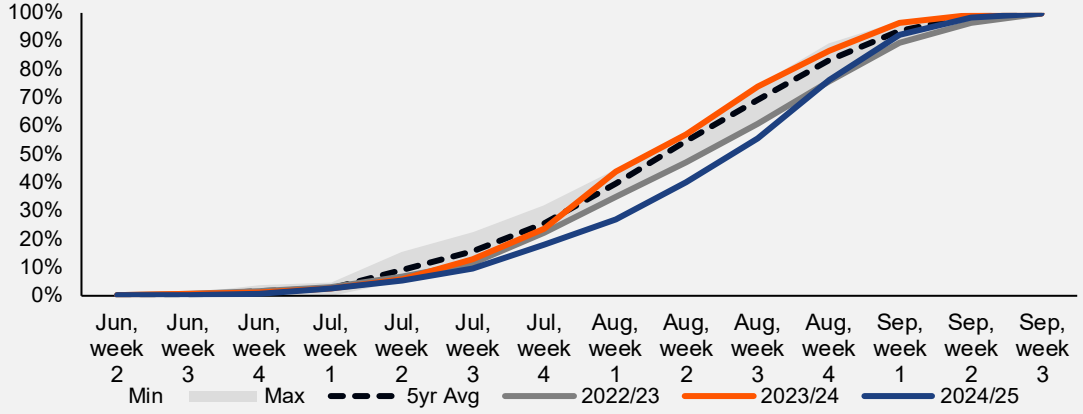
Cotton Production Costs in Mato Grosso (BRL/hectare)

BRL/hectare	2022/23	2023/24	2024/25	2025/26	2026/27e (Feb)	YoY
Seeds	1,030	958	1,006	1,104	1,063	-4%
Fertilizers	3,499	3,766	4,002	3,615	3,649	1%
Pesticides	3,742	3,770	4,620	4,735	4,525	-4%
Others Costs	4,511	4,552	5,548	5,606	5,566	-1%
Cash COGS	**12,781**	**13,046**	**15,175**	**15,059**	**14,803**	**-1.7%**
Unit Revenues	19,107	16,817	15,655	15,448	14,287	-8%
Avg Yield (bag/ha)	141	133	125	125	133	7%
Price Assumption (BRL/bag)	135	127	125	124	107	-13%
Proxy Margin	**6,326**	**3,771**	**480**	**390**	**-516**	**n.a.**
Gross Margin	33%	22%	3%	3%	-4%	n.a.

Cotton Soybean Seeding Progression in Mato Grosso (%)



Cotton Harvesting Progression in Mato Grosso (%)

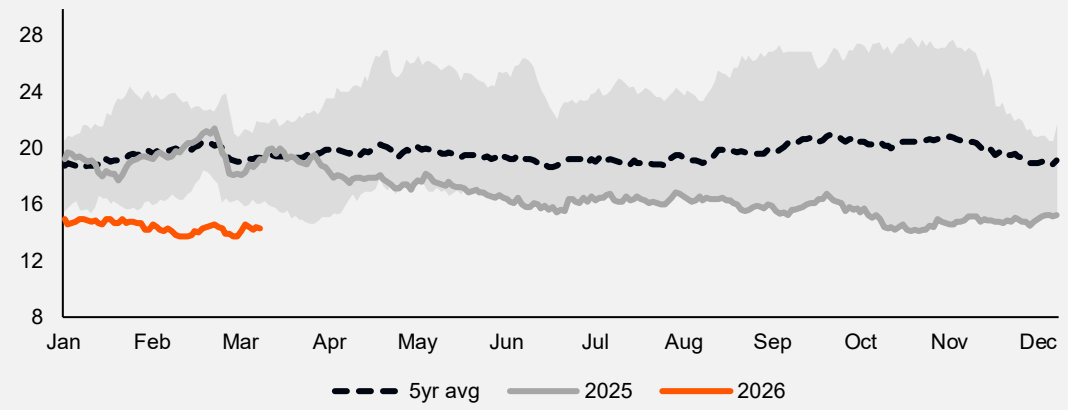


Source: Itaú BBA, IMEA

4 Sugar & Ethanol

Sugar – Prices: Crushing activity in Brazil has nearly concluded, aligning with market expectations; global prices have slightly recovered due to geopolitical conflicts in the Middle East, but still trading around USD 14.4 c/lb

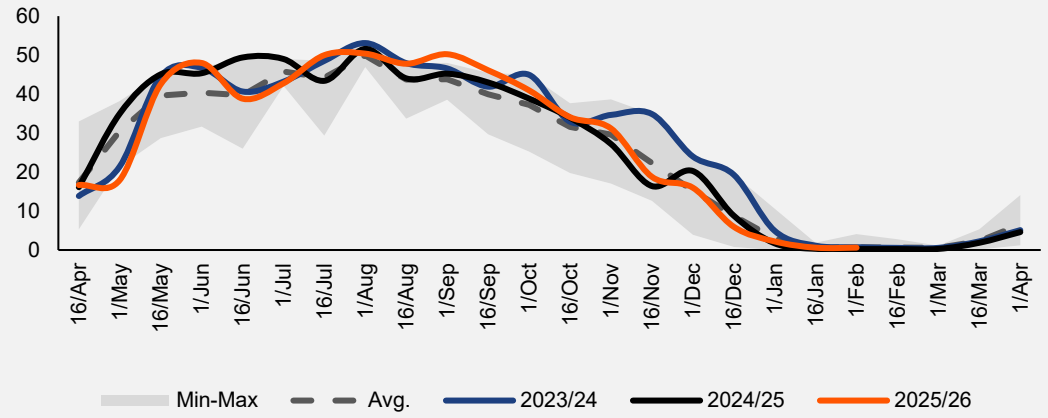
Sugar Prices, New York Reference (@ USDc/lb)



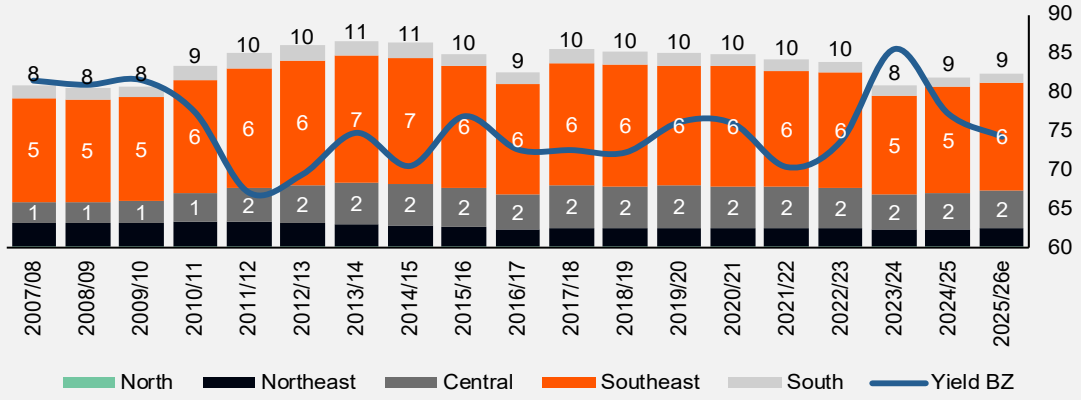
Global Sugar Supply and Demand Outlook (million tons)

	2020/21A	2021/22A	2022/23A	2023/24A	2024/25E	2025/26E
Production	**180**	**181**	**179**	**180**	**181**	**189**
Brazil	42	35	38	46	44	44
India	34	37	37	30	28	35
EU	15	17	14	16	16	15
Use	**172**	**175**	**177**	**178**	**176**	**179**
India	28	29	30	30	30	31
EU	17	17	17	16	16	16
China	16	15	16	16	15	16
Ending Stocks	**50**	**47**	**46**	**45**	**42**	**45**
Stock to Use	29%	27%	26%	25%	24%	25%

Sugarcane Crushing Volumes in Center-South (in million tons)



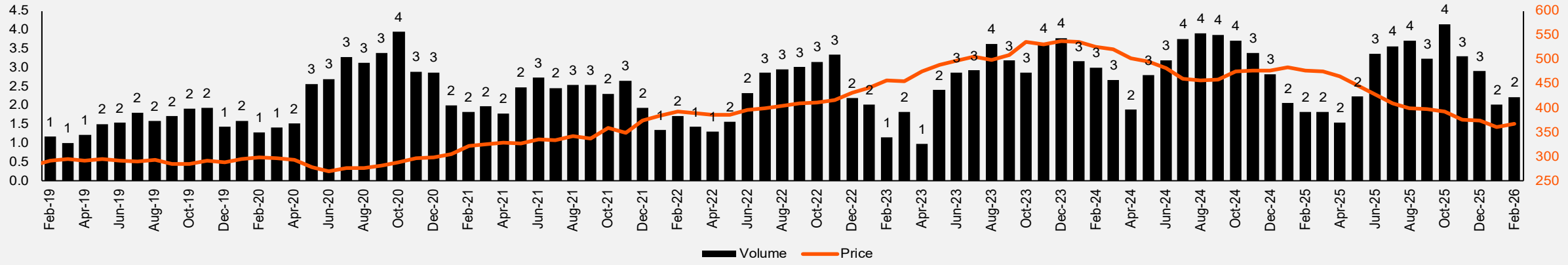
Sugarcane: Brazilian Planted Area (mn ha, LHS) **and Yield** (ton/ha, RHS)



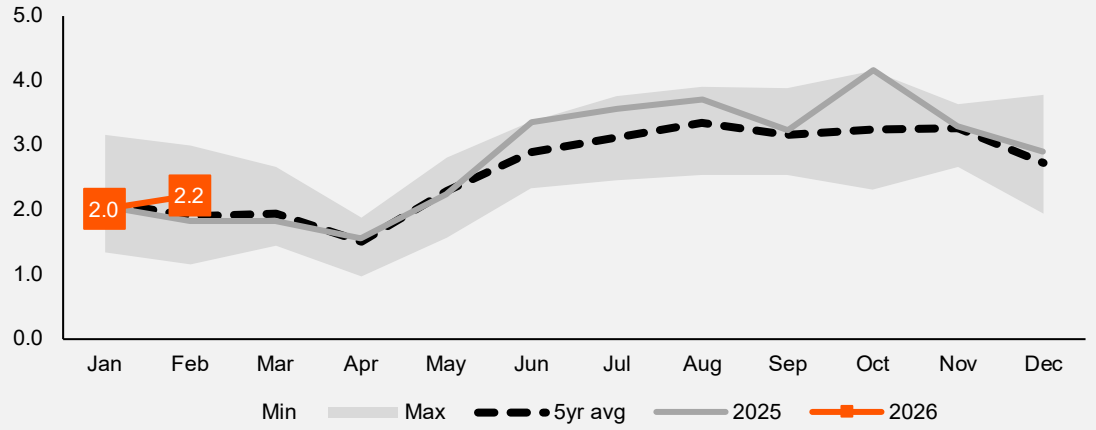
Source: Itaú BBA, Bloomberg, USDA, CONAB, Unica

Sugar – Brazilian Exports: Monthly volumes in February recovered due to harvest development in Brazil, while prices are 6% lower MoM

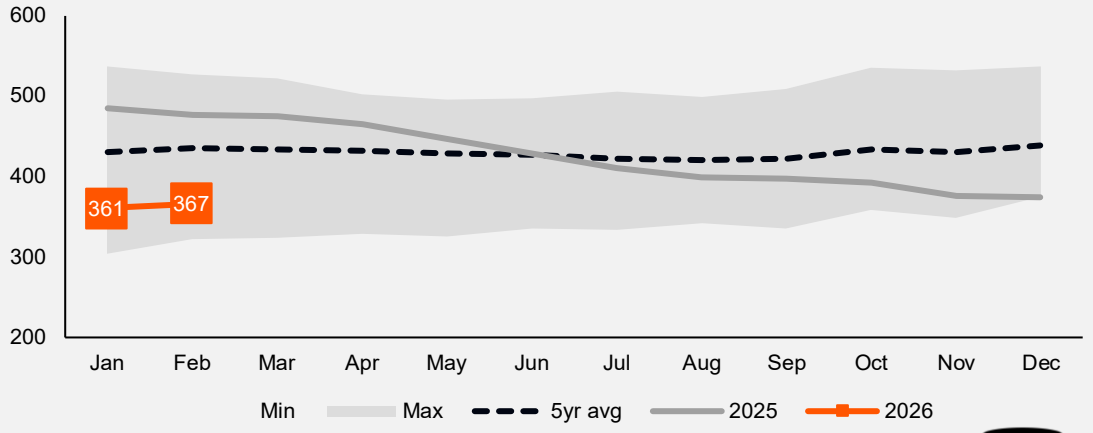
Sugar: Brazil Monthly Export Volumes (million tons) **and Price** (USD/ton)



Sugar: Brazil Monthly Export Volumes (million tons)



Sugar: Brazil Monthly Average Price (USD/ton)

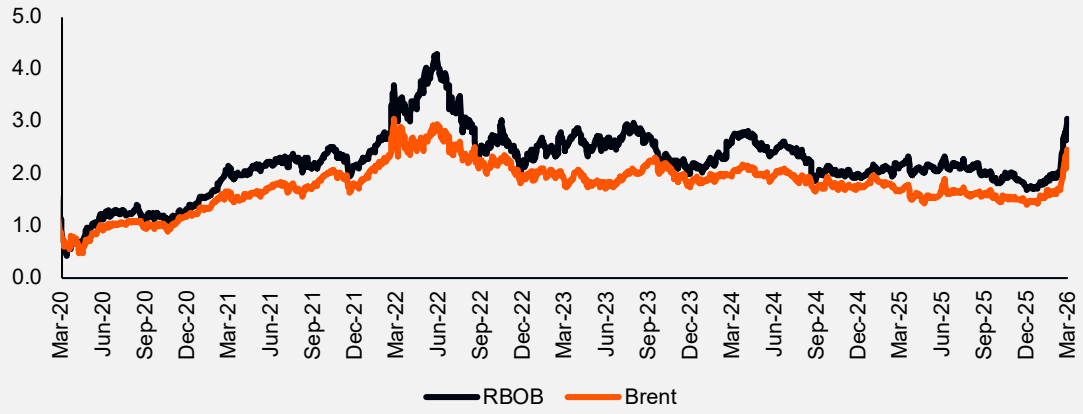


Source: Itaú BBA, SECEX

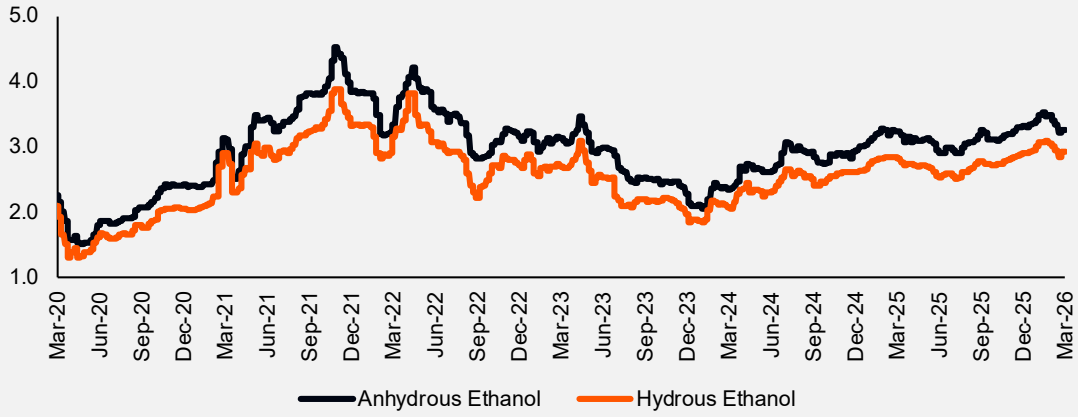
Ethanol, Gasoline & Oil: Ethanol prices have been on an upward trend since October, while sugar prices remain compressed, resulting in S&E equivalent prices that favor ethanol production

Center-South	2022/23	2023/24E	2024/25	2025/26E	2026/27E	YoY
Crushing (million tons)	**548**	**654**	**622**	**605**	**620**	**2%**
Avg TRS (kgs/ton)	141	139	141	138	141	2%
Total TRS (million tons)	77	91	88	83	87	4%
Sugar Mix (%)	**45.8%**	**48.9%**	**48.1%**	**50.9%**	**49.0%**	
Ethanol Mix (%)	54.2%	51.1%	51.9%	49.1%	51.0%	
Sugar (million tons)	**33.7**	**42.4**	**40.2**	**40.4**	**40.7**	**1%**
Ethanol (billion liters)	**29.0**	**33.6**	**35.0**	**33.7**	**36.9**	**9%**
Cane Ethanol	24.6	27.3	26.8	24.1	26.1	8%
Corn Ethanol	4.4	6.3	8.2	9.6	10.8	13%
Hydrous Ethanol	16.7	20.5	22.6	20.5	23.1	13%
Anhydrous Ethanol	12.3	13.1	12.4	13.2	13.8	5%

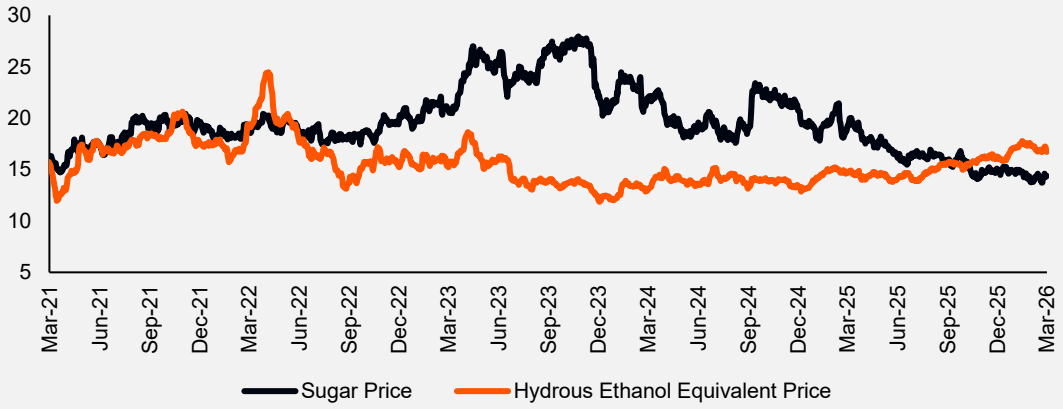
Gasoline (RBOB) **and Oil** (Brent) **Prices in the U.S.** (USD/gallon)



Ethanol Prices in Brazil (BRL/liter)



Brazil Sugar & Ethanol Parity Calculation (USDc/lb)

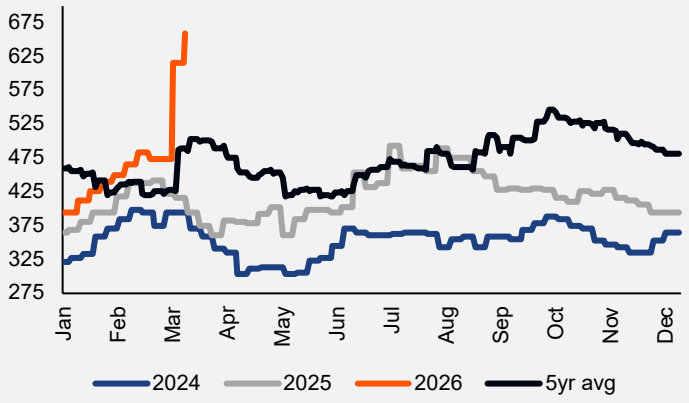


Source: Itaú BBA, UNICA, ANP, Bloomberg

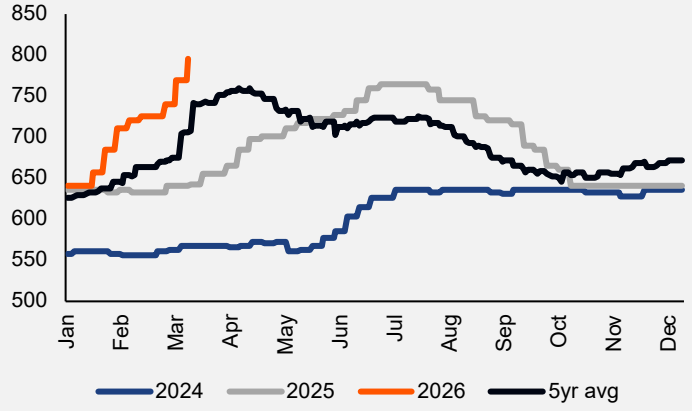
5 Agri Inputs & CFTC Data

Fertilizers – Prices: After a period of price normalization following their peak, fertilizer prices have been increasing sequentially since the beginning of the year, further intensified by recent geopolitical conflicts in the Middle East

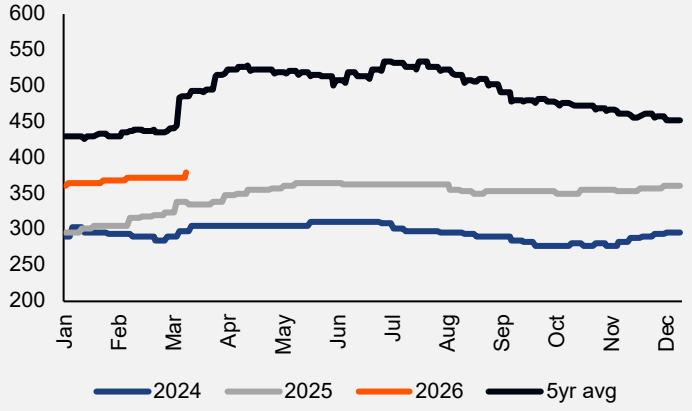
Urea CFR* Price in Brazil (USD/ton)



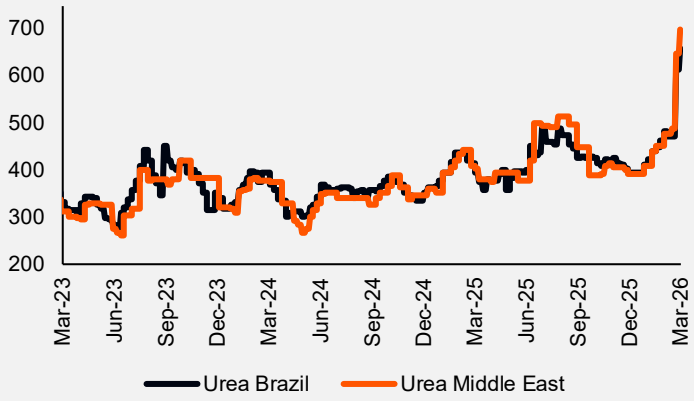
MAP CFR Price in Brazil (USD/ton)



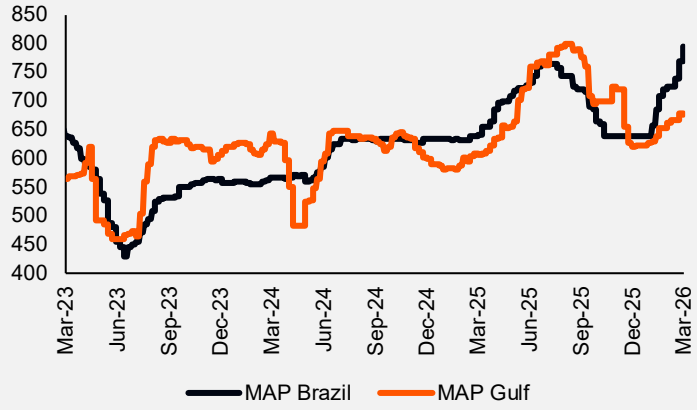
Potassium Chloride CFR Price in Brazil (USD/ton)



Urea Price in Brazil vs. the Middle East (USD/ton)



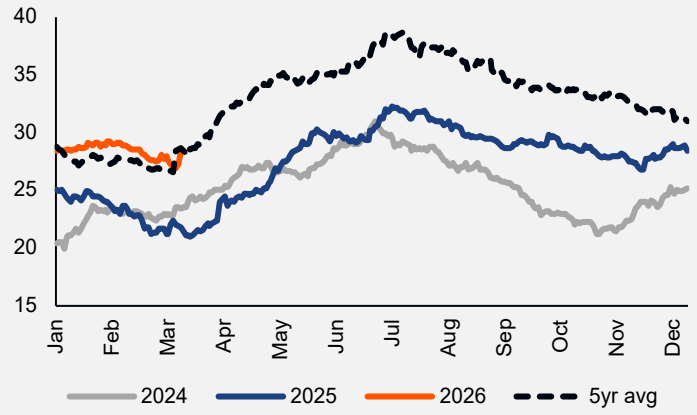
MAP Price in Brazil vs. the Gulf (USD/ton)



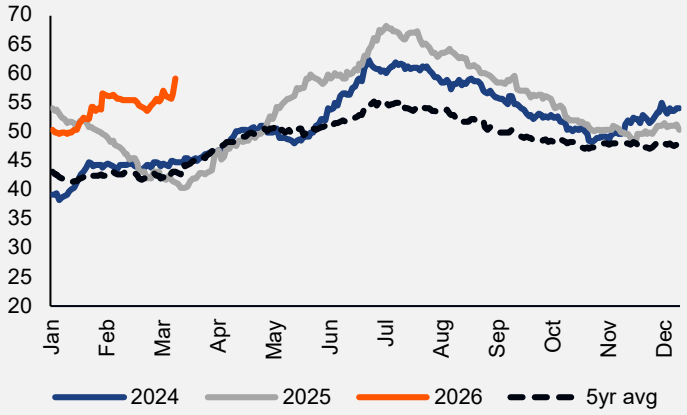
Source: Itaú BBA, Bloomberg; * cost and freight (CFR) prices: quotes consider prices at the ship and do not include insurance and port disembarkation.

Fertilizers – Exchange Ratios: The recent upward trend in fertilizer prices has worsened the exchange ratio for producers, especially for urea products, while grain prices remain at low levels

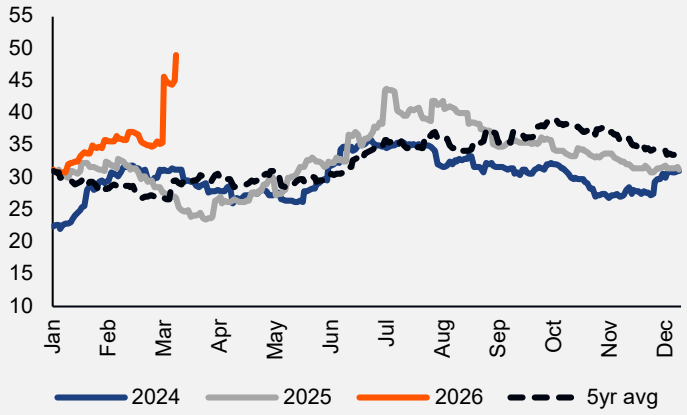
KCl x Corn (ton/bags)



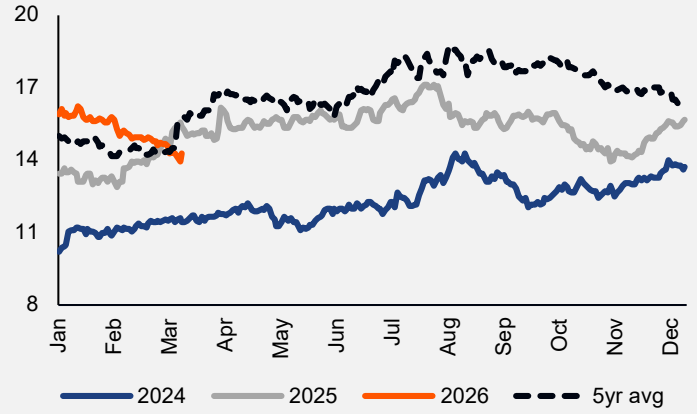
MAP x Corn (ton/bags)



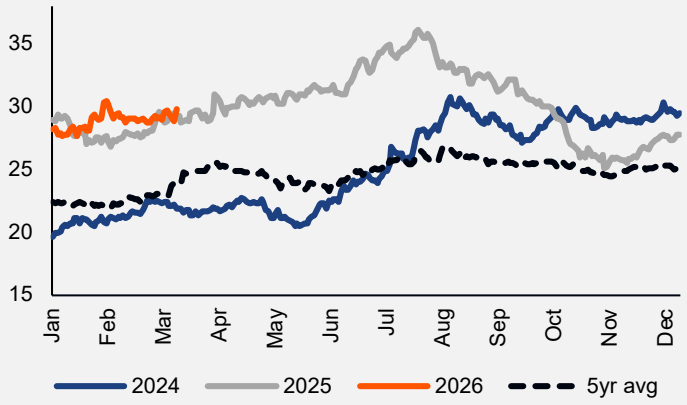
Urea x Corn (ton/bags)



KCl x Soy (ton/bags)



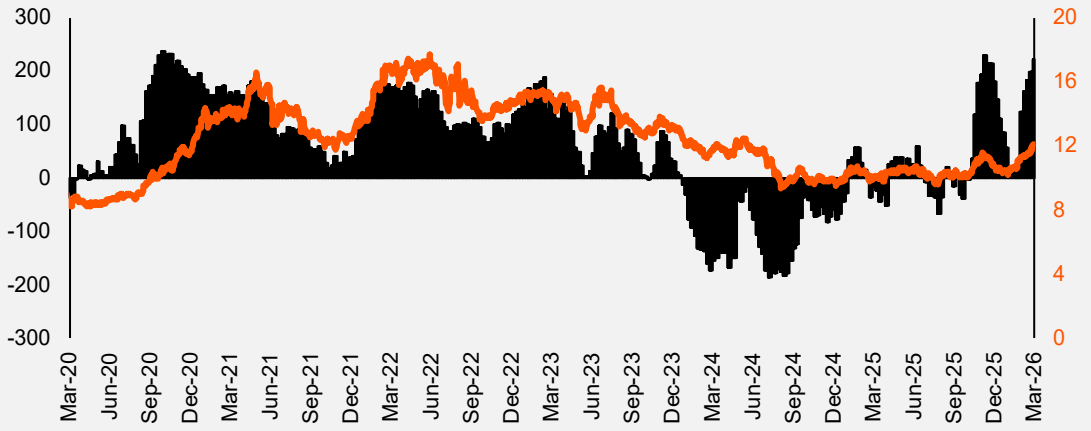
MAP x Soy (ton/bags)



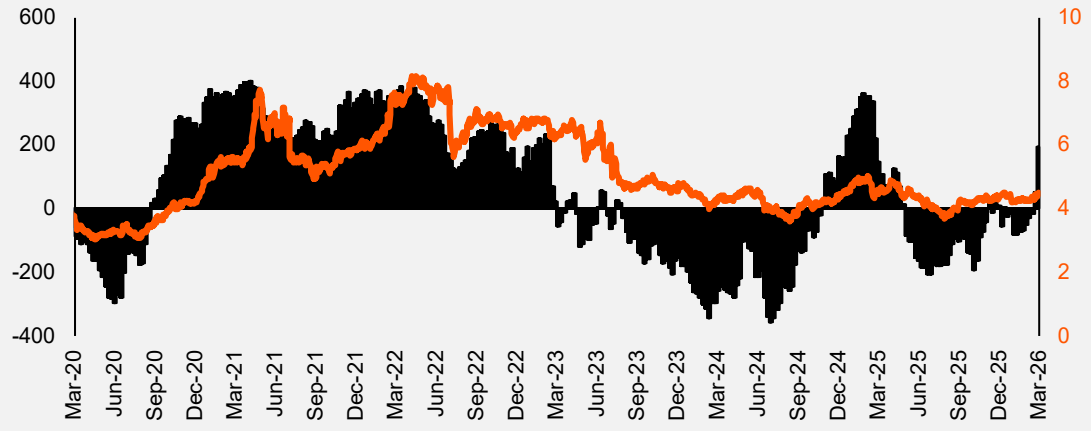
Source: Itaú BBA, Bloomberg; * cost and freight (CFR) prices: quotes consider prices at the ship and do not include insurance and port disembarkation.

CFTC Data – Hedge Funds' Net Position in Commodity Futures & Options: **Following geopolitical conflicts, investors have increased a negative outlook for sugar and cotton, while remaining optimistic about soybeans and corn**

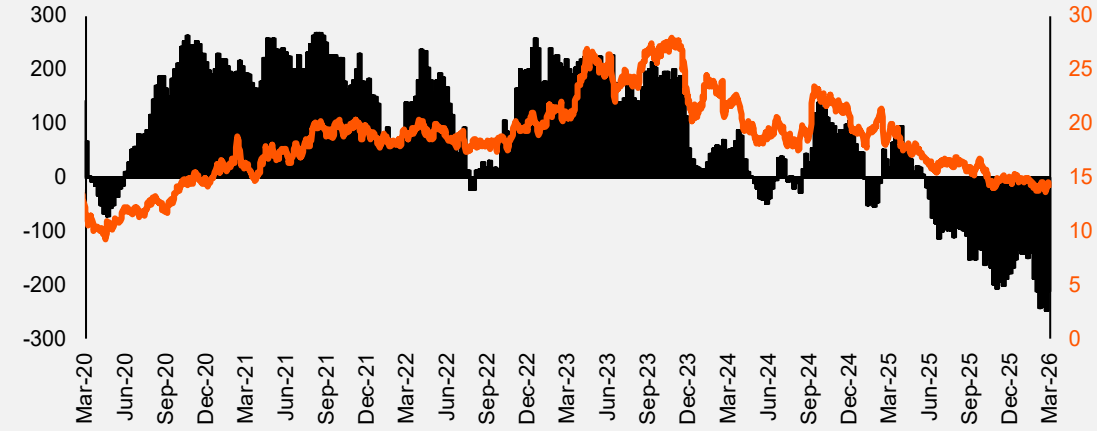
Soybean – Net Position (million contracts) **vs. Commodity Price** (USD/bushel)



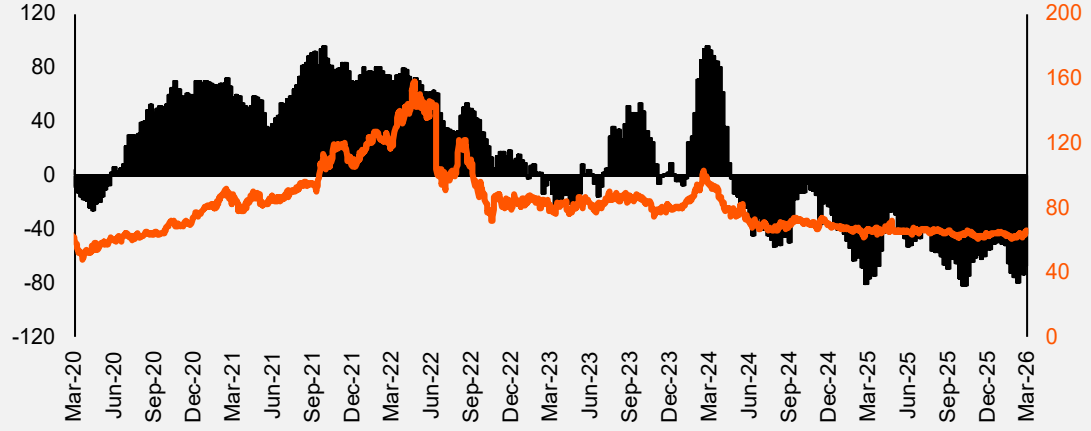
Corn – Net Position (million contracts) **vs. Commodity Price** (USD/bushel)



Sugar – Net Position (million contracts) **vs. Commodity Price** (USDc/lb)



Cotton – Net Position (million contracts) **vs. Commodity Price** (USDc/lb)

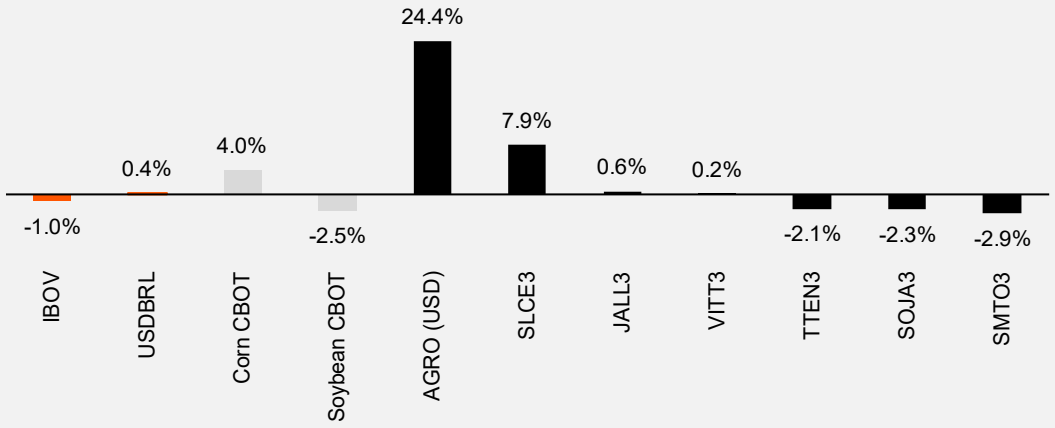


Source: Itaú BBA, Bloomberg

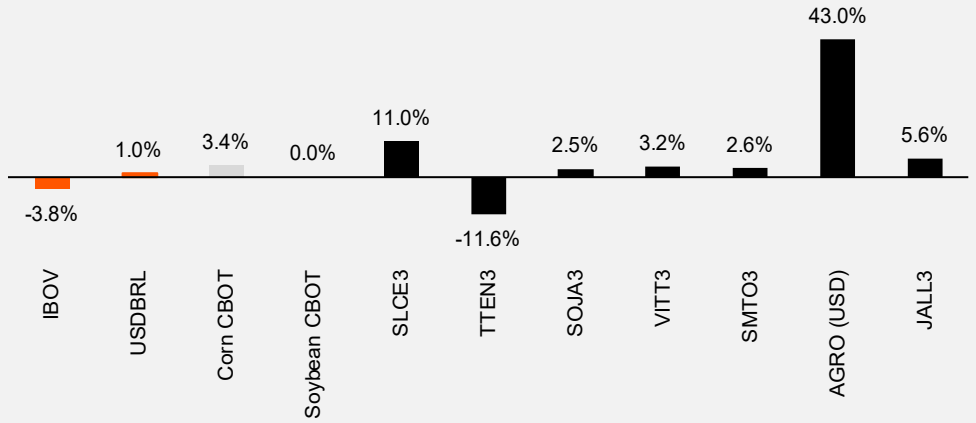
itaú BBA

Stocks Performance

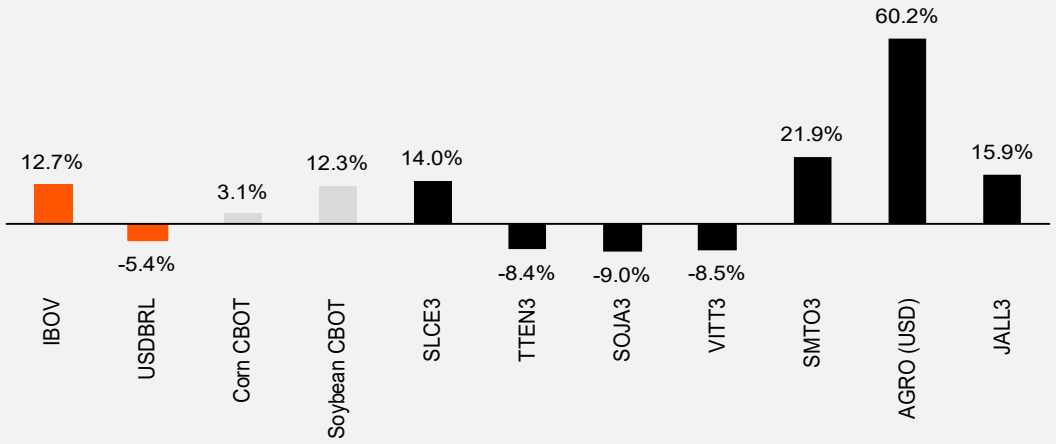
Stocks Performance – Weekly (%)



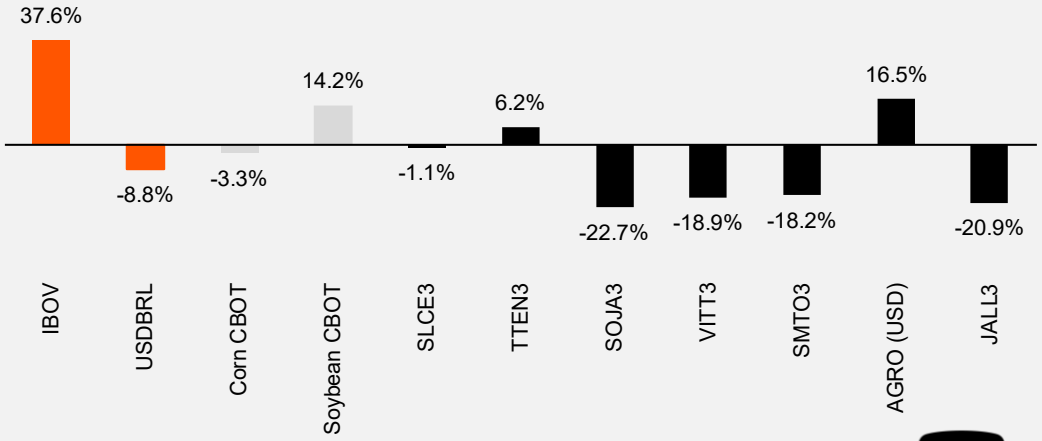
Stocks Performance – MTD (%)



Stocks Performance – YTD (%)



Stocks Performance – LTM (%)



Source: Itaú BBA, Bloomberg

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